Democratic Senate leadership race the newest front in Iran war

送信者: EG US Daily 受信日時: 2026-11-14 01:39

【メール原文】

Democratic Senate leadership race the newest front in Iran war. Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer (D-NY) now has a serious challenger for the major

US Daily
Customize Email Preferences

Democratic Senate leadership race the newest front in Iran war

13 Nov 2026 11:37 EST Discover more on the Portal

*

Democratic Senate leadership race the newest front in Iran war
*
Nvidia scandal will threaten US-China truce in 2027 …
*
… and Howard Lutnick’s job security in 2026

Democratic Senate leadership race the newest front in Iran war. Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer (D-NY) now has a serious challenger for the majority leadership during the next Congress, with Senator Chris Van Hollen (D-MD), a progressive favorite, now having entered the ring.

*

Schumer is still likely to win the leadership contest. Van Hollen doesn’t have broad support within the Democratic caucus (see chart below). Schumer enjoys considerable goodwill from the bulk of the caucus for having delivered Democrats’ largest Senate majority in recent memory and has more powerful allies, particularly most incoming committee chairs and members of the appropriations committee. Van Hollen will be able to unify some progressive Democrats around his candidacy, but that is a relatively small faction.

*

Van Hollen will probably make the Iran war the centerpiece of his campaign and has demanded that Democrats use the 11 December funding deadline as leverage. Schumer doesn’t want to shut down the government next month; an intra-Democratic fracture on the issue increases shutdown risks. Beyond December, making Iran spending a Democratic litmus test sets out a more aggressive Democratic position in next year’s funding fights.

*

A Van Hollen bid that outperforms expectations—even if he loses—could reverberate to the contest for the House speakership in January. If progressives believe that they barely lost the race to unseat Schumer, they will try to carry that momentum into the speakership contest, seeking to displace Hakeem Jeffries (D-NY), the current Democratic leader in the House. Like with Schumer, that could force Jeffries into a more aggressive position on funding in 2027.

*

For Van Hollen, raising his profile among progressives now, via a losing leadership bid, makes strategic sense. If Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (D-NY) doesn't run for president, the progressive lane will be wide-open in 2028, and Van Hollen could see this as an opportunity—even though his name recognition even among Democrats is currently too low to make a serious bid.

Nvidia scandal will threaten US-China truce in 2027 ... The Nvidia scandal has galvanized China hawks in Washington, with Jensen Huang's resignation as CEO removing the industry's most effective lobbyist against chip controls. Congressional negotiators on either side of the aisle would now be seen as defending Nvidia if they tried to strip export control measures from the NDAA, making their passage likely.

*

Nothing suggests President Donald Trump's posture towards China will shift; he still wants a stable relationship. However, China hawks in both Congress and the White House have been empowered recently, and how restrictive the final export control bills are will depend on how much discretion they leave the White House in enforcement.

*

Beijing will likely use the APEC summit in Shenzhen and G20 summit in Florida to pressure Trump against export controls while the NDAA is still being negotiated. Retaliation would likely wait until the bills are finalized, passed, and implemented.

*

We expect Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping to extend the Busan truce beyond 10 January, but the scandal has hardened views of China in Washington, making it harder for the two sides to close gaps on other issues. The greatest risks to the relationship would come from strict enforcement of chip controls passed in the NDAA while Democrats investigate the administration's policies towards China.

*

For more, please see Nvidia scandal will threaten US-China truce in 2027 , 12 November 2026.

... and Howard Lutnick's job security in 2026. As further details about the Nvidia and Megaspeed scandal emerge, political pressure is mounting on Secretary of Commerce Howard Lutnick and Commerce's Bureau of Industry and Security head Jeffrey Kessler.

*

The next few weeks are essential to Lutnick's survival: firing him (or, more likely, moving him to a newly created position) deflects criticism from Trump only if it happens before narratives of corruption or impropriety solidify.

*

Kessler is an easier target and would likely go first. He is lower ranking and reportedly more directly involved in the decisions to pause investigations and slow-walk export-control enforcement. Kessler's potential removal is a signpost for Lutnick's survival as well: if Kessler is removed in the next few days and the story doesn't subside, it will put Lutnick squarely in the crosshairs.

*

Replacing Lutnick is an uncertain path, but would likely push toward a relatively more hawkish approach to China and export controls, in line with the position reportedly held by many of Trump's other senior advisors.

Quote of the Day

"I'll make the determination at the beginning of the year. So we'll spend the next few weeks with the family and make a decision early February." - California Governor Gavin Newsom announcing a timeline for his decision to run for president in an interview with Turkish state media. Expect February to be, in effect, the beginning of the long presidential campaign cycle, with a number of candidates formally entering the race.

On the Radar

18-19 November: APEC leaders meeting in China

11 December: Government funding runs out

14-15 December: G20 summit in Florida

15 December: Senator-elect Sherrod Brown (D-OH) is sworn in, reducing Republicans' Senate majority to 52-48

3 January: New Congress is sworn in

10 January: US-China tariff truce expires

Clayton Allen
Practice Head, United States
+1 202.903.0027
allen@eurasiagroup.net
Noah Daponte-Smith
Senior Analyst, United States
daponte-smith@eurasiagroup.net
Kendal Walker
Senior Analyst, United States
walker@eurasiagroup.net
Jason Walter
Researcher, United States
walter@eurasiagroup.net
David Meale
Practice Head, China
2025405135
Meale@eurasiagroup.net
EG US Daily
unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net
Now on iOS and Android
Get the Eurasia Group app
Read anywhere · Receive notifications · Reach out to analysts
App Store
Google Play

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.
X-HG-DocID cmwf6yqw9j3yr07lgzl9fs63x

Opt Out | Customize Email Preferences